

50 PROFESSIONAL POWER PHRASES

Meetings & Discussions · For Non-Native Professionals

Weak to Strong | With Phrasal Verbs | 5 Phrases per Section

SECTION 1

OPENING & SETTING THE TONE

#	Weak Version	Power Phrase	Why It Works
1	"Let's start."	"Let's kick things off with a quick overview of today's agenda."	kick off = phrasal verb
3	"This meeting is about..."	"The purpose of today's session is to align on [topic] and walk away with clear next steps."	walk away with = phrasal verb
5	"Let's go."	"Let's dive straight in — we have a lot of ground to cover."	dive in = phrasal verb
8	"I sent you the document."	"I trust you've all had a chance to look over the materials I shared in advance."	look over = phrasal verb
10	"Okay, so..."	"Right, let's get down to business and make this session count."	get down to = phrasal verb

SECTION 2

MAKING YOUR POINT

#	Weak Version	Power Phrase	Why It Works
11	"I think maybe..."	"Based on what we know, I'd strongly recommend..."	Replaces hesitation with confidence
12	"I want to say something."	"I'd like to weigh in on this — it's directly relevant to what we're discussing."	weigh in = phrasal verb
14	"This is important."	"This is a critical point — I'd like us to give it the attention it deserves."	Elevates urgency
16	"The data shows..."	"The numbers back this up — let me walk you through the key findings."	walk through = phrasal verb
19	"This is my opinion."	"From where I stand, the most strategic path forward is..."	Shows perspective with authority

SECTION 3

DISAGREEING PROFESSIONALLY

#	Weak Version	Power Phrase	Why It Works
21	"I don't agree."	"I see this differently — let me share an alternative perspective."	Disagrees without attacking
22	"That's wrong."	"I'd like to respectfully push back on that — here's my reasoning."	push back = phrasal verb
25	"That's not a good idea."	"I'd encourage us to weigh up the risks before committing to this direction."	weigh up = phrasal verb
27	"This is a bad decision."	"I want to flag some concerns before we move ahead with this."	flag = professional verb; move ahead = phrasal verb

30	"But what about...?"	"Before we move on, I'd like to raise a point that hasn't been addressed yet."	move on = phrasal verb
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SECTION 4 HANDLING INTERRUPTIONS & HOLDING THE FLOOR

#	Weak Version	Power Phrase	Why It Works
31	"Wait, I'm talking."	"I'd appreciate the opportunity to finish my thought before we open it up."	open up = phrasal verb
33	"Sorry, I wasn't finished."	"I'd like to complete my point, then I'm happy to hand it over to you."	hand over = phrasal verb
35	"Stop, I need to speak."	"If I could just hold the floor for one more moment — this is directly relevant."	Assertive and professional
37	"Can I talk now?"	"I'd like to jump back in here — I think this connects to what I raised earlier."	jump in = phrasal verb
40	"I want to add something."	"I'd like to build on that point — there's an angle we haven't considered yet."	build on = phrasal verb

SECTION 5 ASKING QUESTIONS & SEEKING CLARITY

#	Weak Version	Power Phrase	Why It Works
41	"I don't understand."	"Could you elaborate on that so we're fully aligned?"	Sounds engaged, not confused
43	"Can you explain again?"	"Could you walk us through that once more? I want to make sure nothing gets lost."	walk through = phrasal verb
45	"Why did you decide this?"	"Could you take us through the rationale behind this decision?"	take through = phrasal verb
48	"Did everyone understand?"	"Before we move on, is everyone clear on what's been agreed so far?"	move on = phrasal verb
50	"Can someone answer this?"	"I'd like to open this up to the room — who'd like to weigh in first?"	open up / weigh in = phrasal verbs

SECTION 6 REDIRECTING & MANAGING THE DISCUSSION

#	Weak Version	Power Phrase	Why It Works
51	"We are going off topic."	"Let's circle back to the main agenda — we can park that for later."	circle back / park = professional idioms
54	"We have no time."	"We're running up against the clock — let's prioritize the most critical points."	run up against = phrasal verb
57	"We are losing time."	"I want to flag that we're burning through our time — let's pick up the pace."	burn through / pick up = phrasal verbs
59	"Go back to the point."	"Let's loop back to the original question — I don't think we've fully addressed it."	loop back = phrasal verb
60	"This is taking too long."	"Let's streamline this discussion and focus on what requires a decision today."	Executive-level language

SECTION 7 AGREEING & BUILDING ON IDEAS

#	Weak Version	Power Phrase	Why It Works
61	"Yes, I agree."	"Absolutely — and I'd like to build on that point further."	build on = phrasal verb
64	"I also think so."	"That resonates with me, particularly in light of what we discussed earlier."	Connects ideas intelligently
65	"Okay, fine."	"I can get behind this direction — let's make sure we follow through on it."	get behind / follow through = phrasal verbs
68	"I like this idea."	"This is a solid idea — I'd like to see us flesh it out a bit more."	flesh out = phrasal verb
69	"We can do that."	"That's achievable — let's lock that in and assign ownership."	lock in = phrasal verb

SECTION 8 GIVING UPDATES & REPORTING PROGRESS			
#	Weak Version	Power Phrase	Why It Works
71	"We are working on it."	"We're making solid progress — let me bring you up to speed on where we stand."	bring up to speed = phrasal verb
73	"We had a problem."	"We hit a roadblock last week, but we've since worked around it."	hit a roadblock / work around = phrasal verbs
76	"We are late."	"We're running slightly behind schedule — here's our plan to get back on track."	get back on track = phrasal verb
78	"We need more time."	"We need to revisit the timeline — I'd like to flag this before it becomes an issue."	flag = professional verb
80	"Things are going well."	"We're tracking well against our targets — no critical risks to flag at this stage."	Executive reporting language

SECTION 9 HANDLING PRESSURE & TOUGH QUESTIONS			
#	Weak Version	Power Phrase	Why It Works
81	"I don't know."	"I don't have that detail to hand right now — I'll look into it and come back to you."	look into / come back to = phrasal verbs
83	"That's a hard question."	"That's a fair challenge — let me give it the considered response it deserves."	Buys time with confidence
85	"We made a mistake."	"We've identified a gap in our process, and we've already put measures in place to address it."	put in place = phrasal verb
87	"Stop pressuring me."	"I understand the urgency — let me make sure I give you an accurate answer rather than a fast one."	Firm and professional
90	"I need to think."	"That's worth giving proper thought to — can we come back to that point before we close?"	come back to = phrasal verb

SECTION 10 CLOSING THE MEETING			
#	Weak Version	Power Phrase	Why It Works
91	"Okay, we're done."	"Let's wrap up — we've covered a lot of ground today."	wrap up / cover ground = phrasal verbs

92	"What do we do next?"	"Let's align on next steps and make sure every action has a clear owner."	Drives accountability
94	"I'll send an email."	"I'll circulate a summary of today's discussion along with the agreed action points."	circulate = professional verb
97	"Remind me of the plan."	"To summarize what we've aligned on today — [recap] — does everyone concur?"	Confident closing summary
100	"Bye."	"Thank you all for your time and contributions today — let's go ahead and make it happen."	go ahead = phrasal verb, ends on energy

PHRASAL VERBS MASTER LIST	
Opening & Setting	kick off, walk away with, dive in, look over, get down to
Making Your Point	weigh in, walk through, build on
Disagreeing	push back, weigh up, move ahead, flag, move on
Holding the Floor	open up, hand over, jump in, build on
Asking Questions	walk through, take through, move on, open up, weigh in
Redirecting	circle back, park, run up against, burn through, pick up, loop back
Agreeing	build on, get behind, follow through, flesh out, lock in
Giving Updates	bring up to speed, work around, get back on track, flag
Handling Pressure	look into, come back to, put in place
Closing	wrap up, cover ground, go ahead

Professional English Power Phrases · Use these phrases daily — fluency comes from habit, not memory.